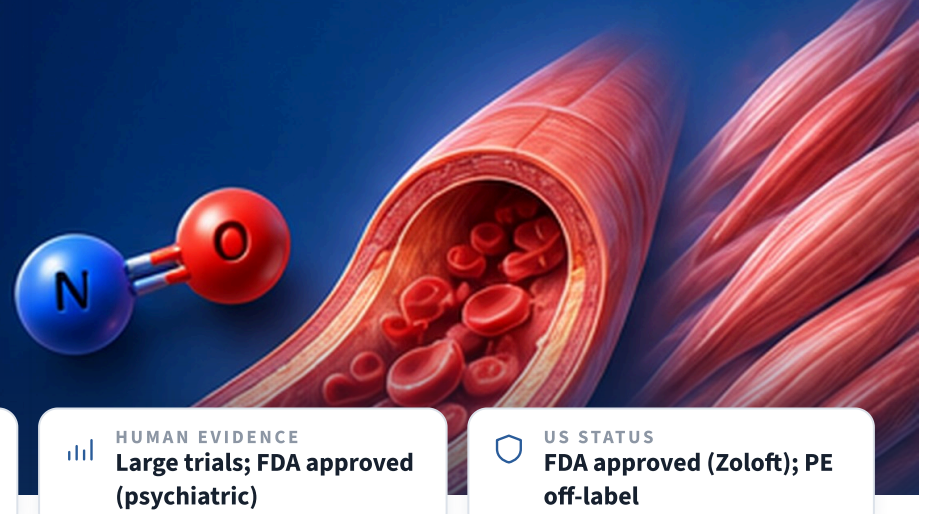
VITALITY 06

Sertraline (Zoloft)

SSRI antidepressant (selective serotonin reuptake inhibitor) taken by mouth



CLASS	STUDIED FOR	HUMAN EVIDENCE	US STATUS
SSRI antidepressant	Depression, premature ejaculation	Large trials; FDA approved (psychiatric)	FDA approved (Zoloft); PE off-label

STUDIED FOR

- **Depression, anxiety** — HUMAN
- **Premature ejaculation** — HUMAN

PE use is off-label. A 2019 pooled analysis of 14 trials covered 977 men with PE. Most trials lasted 4 to 8 weeks.

HOW IT WORKS IN THE BODY

Sertraline ▶ Reuptake blocked ▶ More serotonin ▶ Ejaculation delay

- **Blocks serotonin reuptake** by nerve cells, per the label
- **Very weak effects** on noradrenaline and dopamine
- **Delayed ejaculation** is a known SSRI side effect, the basis for PE studies

EVIDENCE & WHAT'S KNOWN

EVIDENCE

FDA APPROVED
LEVEL 5 OF 5

- Approved for depression in 1991
- PE: small RCTs of 36 to 147 men
- PE pooled analysis: 977 men, 14 trials

NOT YET ESTABLISHED

- Long-term use for PE
- Large trials for PE

QUICK PRACTICAL INFO

HALF-LIFE	ROUTES STUDIED
About 26 hours	By mouth (tablets, oral solution)
PHARMACOKINETICS	**SOLD AS**
Peak in 4.5 to 8.4 hours; extensively metabolized	Prescription tablets and solution (Zoloft, generics)
MONITORED IN TRIALS	**SPORT (WADA)**
Mood and suicidal thoughts, sodium, bleeding, sexual effects	Not on the 2026 list

REGULATORY

FDA	Approved 1991 for 6 psychiatric uses; PE off-label
MHRA	Oct 2026: warning on lasting sexual problems
WADA	Not on the 2026 list

REFERENCES

1. FDA, Zoloft prescribing information (DailyMed), Jul 2025
2. Yi et al., Medicine (Baltimore), sertraline for PE meta-analysis, Jun 2019
3. MHRA, Drug Safety Update on antidepressants, Oct 2026

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